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Presidential Telephone Calls - Memorandum of Conversations 10/24/89 - 12/26/89

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THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: The President's Telephone Call to Prime Minister Wilfried Martens of Belgium (U)

PARTICIPANTS: The President
Wilfried Martens, Prime Minister
Notetaker: Robert L. Hutchings

DATE, TIME November 25, 1989, 7:46 - 7:50 a.m. EST
AND PLACE: Camp David

The President initiated the call. (U)

The President: How are you, sir? (U)

Prime Minister Martens: Very fine. I had a Party meeting this morning. I apologize for being late to receive your call. (U)

The President: I just wanted to tell you that Manfred Woerner has invited me to come to Brussels December 4 to report on my meetings with Gorbachev. I have accepted. This is a good chance to get together. I look forward to seeing you and hope we have time for a brief chat. I am anxious to get the opinions of friends before I go. Do you have any thoughts for me? (U)

Prime Minister Martens: No. We had a good meeting Saturday in Paris. We are all agreed that the Allies must consult closely. Chancellor Kohl assured us that he will defend Germany's strong role in the EC and NATO. I have no doubt that you will defend our position in your meetings with Gorbachev. In Belgium, we see no difficulties. (U)

The President: It will be an important meeting, and very timely. There will be no surprises or deals. I was intrigued with Belgium's idea of a "second tier" closely associated with the EC which would give Poland and Hungary, and perhaps other East European countries, the chance to move closer to the Community. This is something to discuss with Gorbachev. (U)

Prime Minister Martens: The U.S. role is very important, especially with Poland and Hungary. Chancellor Kohl also mentioned your involvement. In Paris, we agreed that we should help only those countries that accept free elections. (U)

The President: It is interesting that now Czechoslovakia is beginning to move. Only Romania is swimming against the tide. I just wanted to check in with you. I believe in close consultations. (U)

-- End of Conversation --

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